

Timeline of Writing Systems' Graphical Evolution

Central & East Asia

Legend

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Hellenic: Scripts derived from Greek

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Sinitic: Scripts derived from Oracle Bone

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Northern Brahmi: Scripts derived from Brahmi in North India

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Semitic: Scripts derived from Proto-Sinaitic

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Southern Brahmi: Scripts derived from Brahmi in South India

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Other: Independently derived scripts (graphically)

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Writing direction

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Logograph: Words are distinct characters

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Syllabary: Syllables are distinct characters

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True alphabet: Consonants are distinct characters

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True alphabet: Vowels are on par with consonants

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Abugida: Vowels are secondary, usually diacritics

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Abjad: Vowels are optional or non-existent

South Asia

Southeast Asia

West Asia

Africa

Europe, Anatolia & Caucasus

Americas

